

Groundcover plants for shade

An area that is shaded for some or most of the day may be regarded by some gardeners as a problem space, when in fact it should be viewed as an opportunity to experiment with a different, and often equally exciting, range of plants. The following groundcover plants will provide a wealth of colorful flowers and foliage, and may be planted in even deep shade, provided the soil is reasonably fertile. Where the shade is caused by trees and large shrubs, the soil will also be very dry. Keep new plants well watered during their first year until established.

SHRUBS

Cotoneaster conspicuus, p.142
Cotoneaster 'Gnom'
Cotoneaster salicifolius 'Herbstfeuer'
Daphne laureola subsp. *philippi*, p.147
Epigaea asiatica
Euonymus fortunei 'Kewensis'
Gaultheria shallon, p.154
Hypericum calycinum, p.161
Leucothoe fontanesiana
Lonicera ligustrina var. *pileata*, p.167
Mahonia aquifolium, p.148
Mahonia repens
Prunus laurocerasus 'Otto Luyken', p.145
Rubus tricolor
Ruscus hypoglossum, p.167
Sarcococca confusa, p.142
Sarcococca hookeriana var. *humilis*, p.164
Vinca spp., pp.164, 165

CLIMBERS AND WALL SHRUBS

Hedera spp. and cvs, p.211

PERENNIALS

Acanthus spinosus, p.239
Ajuga pyramidalis
Ajuga reptans 'Atropurpurea'
Alchemilla mollis, p.275
Anemone apennina
Anemone tomentosa
Arisarum proboscideum
Asarum caudatum
Astrantia maxima, p.278
Brunnera macrophylla
Brunnera macrophylla 'Jack Frost', p.261
Chelidonium majus 'Flore Pleno', p.227
Chrysosplenium macrophyllum, p.256
Convallaria majalis, p.255
Dicentra formosa
Duchesnea indica
Epimedium epsteinii, p.260
Epimedium 'Amber Queen', p.263
Epimedium davidii
Epimedium perralderianum
Euphorbia amygdaloides var. *robbiae*, p.262
Galium odoratum, p.263
Geranium macrorrhizum, p.269
Geranium renardii, p.264
Glechoma hederacea 'Variegata', p.277
HEUCHERA, p.282
HOSTAS (some), pp.272–273
Hypsela reniformis
Lamium maculatum and cvs, pp.254, 255
Lamprocapnos spectabilis, p.223
Liriope muscari, p.280
LUNGWORTS, p.261
Meehania urticifolia
Omphalodes cappadocica
Pachyphragma macrophyllum, p.255
Plectranthus oertendahlii
Symphytum ibericum

Tellima grandiflora Rubra Group, p.279
Tolmiea menziesii
Vancouveria hexandra

Grasses and bamboos

Chasmanthium latifolium, p.288
Luzula sylvatica 'Hohe Tatra', p.288
Phalaris arundinacea var. *picta*

Ferns

Adiantum venustum, p.292
Athyrium spp. and cvs p.290
Blechnum penna-marina, p.290
Blechnum spicant
Polypodium cambricum 'Richard Kayse', p.293
Polypodium vulgare and cvs, p.291
Polystichum setiferum groups, pp.291

ROCK PLANTS

Asarina procumbens, p.371
Asarum europaeum, p.375
Campanula portenschlagiana, p.368
Campanula poscharskyana, p.367
Cardamine trifolia, p.348
Ceratostigma plumbaginoides, p.346
Cornus canadensis, p.360
Galax urceolata, p.336
Geranium sanguineum, p.340
Homogyne alpina
Maianthemum bifolium, p.348
Mitchella repens
Pachysandra terminalis, p.375
Persicaria affinis 'Donald Lowndes', p.365
Prunella grandiflora, p.368
Saxifraga stolonifera
Saxifraga x urbium
Tiarella cordifolia, p.333
Viola riviniana Purpurea Group p.355
Waldsteinia ternata, p.372

TENDER AND EXOTIC PLANTS

Perennials

Fittonia albivenis Argyroneura Group, p.468
Fittonia albivenis Verschaffeltii Group

RIGHT A covering in shade

Ferns, hostas, and heucheras fill space and offer interesting textures and contrasts in shady corners.



Astrantia maxima



Geranium sanguineum



Convallaria majalis



Epimedium 'Amber Queen'

